

WEBSITE REDESIGN PROPOSAL

A new look for the McRoberts website

Built only from what our school already has.

FOR

Mr. Jason Leslie, Principal

FROM

Ali Rajool, McRoberts parent and PAC Co-Treasurer

DATE

October 2026

Hi Mr. Leslie,

Our school website has a lot of good information, but it is hard to use, especially on a phone. On a phone, a parent who wants to report an absence has to scroll almost four screens down the home page to find the number, and the bell schedule is a picture that is too small to read. I took the site's own pages and built a working preview of a new design. It keeps the crest and every word as they are today, and it stays on Drupal 10, so it can be added as a new theme without changing the text of any page.

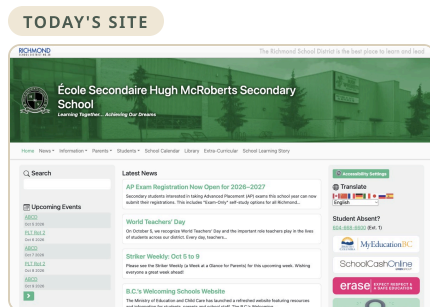
WHAT I AM ASKING

Your feedback.

Please open the preview on your phone and on a computer, and tell me what works and what doesn't. If you like the direction, I would be happy to walk you through it.

Open the live preview

<https://rajool.github.io/mcroberts-redesign/>



The home page.

The crest, our name and our motto lead the page, with the top tasks right under them and the absence number in the top bar of every page (on a phone, a call button in the bottom bar). The yellow bar shows how an alert from the school would look.



What stays exactly the same



The crest

Used exactly as it is: no new colours, no cropping, no redrawing. The site's green comes from the crest.



Every word

Every heading, menu label and page uses words that are on our site today. A check compares each page with the live site and finds 0 new words.



Drupal 10 and the district's setup

The same content and views; no page text is edited. A new theme plus settings for menus, page addresses (old ones redirect) and blocks. The bell schedule and a few home-page sentences are kept in the theme.



Easy to undo

Two steps: make the current theme the default again, then run the undo script that comes with the theme. It puts back today's menu, page addresses and any retired pages.

A simpler site structure

Seven menus, named after what people come for, each with the most requested pages first.
A slim bar on every page holds the absence line and the main sign-ins.

ON EVERY PAGE

Student Absent? 604-668-6600 (Ext. 1)

MyEducation BC

School Cash Online

Office 365

Contact Us

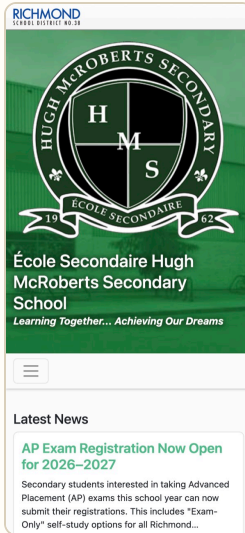
1 Parents Student Attendance School Cash Online MyEd Parent Portal: Request Assistance Learning Updates Universal Hot Lunch @ McRoberts +15 more in Welcome to McRoberts, Resources for Parents, Important information for parents, Parent Advisory Committee (PAC)	2 Students Student Login MyEd Student Portal: Request Assistance Counselling Centre Career Centre Information Grad 2027 +13 more in Academic Support, Required for Graduation, Career Exploration	3 School Calendar Bell Schedule Personal Learning Time (PLT) Snow and Extreme Weather Protocols Subscribe to our calendar	4 News Newsletters School Learning Story
5 Extra-Curricular Strikers Athletics Club Directory Athletics Info for Parents District Concussion Protocol	6 Library Library Catalogue Digital Resources Read & Listen Make & Play Q & A Biblio Bites: A Monthly Library Newsletter	7 About Us Contact Us Our Staff Mission Statement French Immersion Program Catchment Donations	Tree test 92.3% the new menu 73.1% today's menu In a blind tree test with simulated testers and 26 everyday tasks, the new menu led to the right page 92.3% of the time, against 73.1% for today's menu. With two testers each, one task is worth about 4 points, so read these as a direction.

The biggest improvements

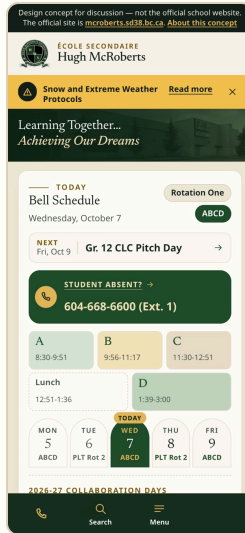
Each pair shows the same view: today's site on the left, the redesign on the right.

1 The first screen on a phone

TODAY'S SITE



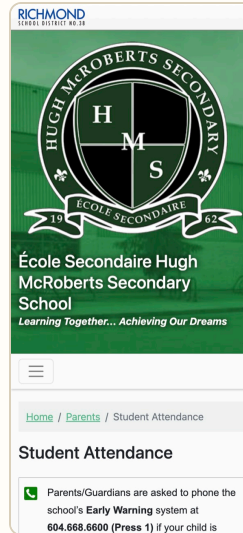
REDESIGN



The first screen now shows the day's blocks, the next event and a one-tap call to report an absence. Today that number is almost four screens down.

2 Reporting an absence

TODAY'S SITE



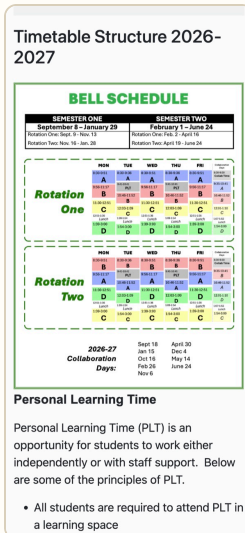
REDESIGN



The page starts right away, and the Early Warning number is a button that calls it. Today the title starts near the bottom of the screen and the number is plain text, not a call link.

3 The bell schedule

TODAY'S SITE



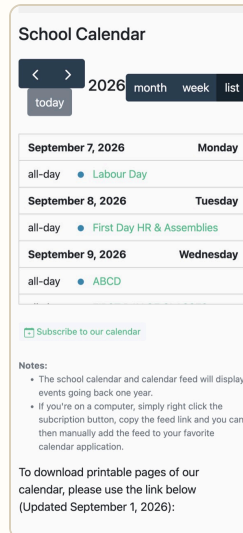
REDESIGN



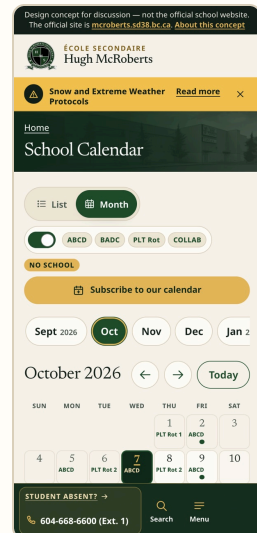
The timetable is real text and tables that show today's blocks and what comes next. Today it is a picture, and on a phone its times are about 3 pixels tall.

4 The school calendar

TODAY'S SITE



REDESIGN

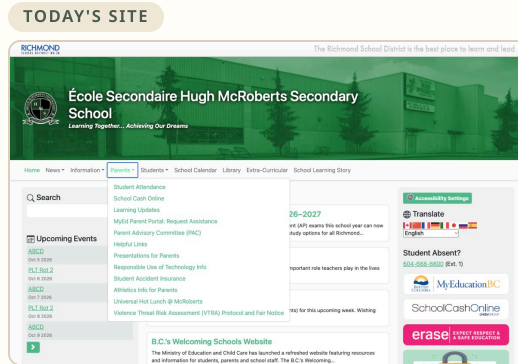


The calendar is a full-width list by month, No School days are marked, and the timetable codes are small tags you can hide. Today it is a small scroll box that starts in early September.

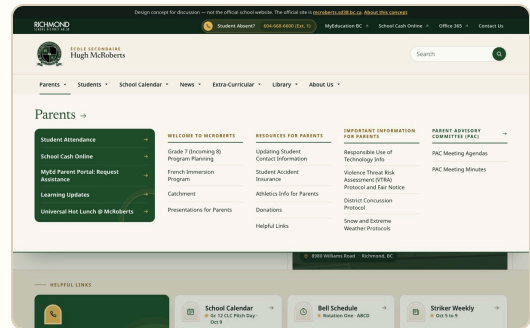
5

The menu

Each menu opens one clear panel, with the most requested pages first and the rest in labelled groups. Today some pages, like Strikers Athletics and Club Directory, are not in the menu at all.



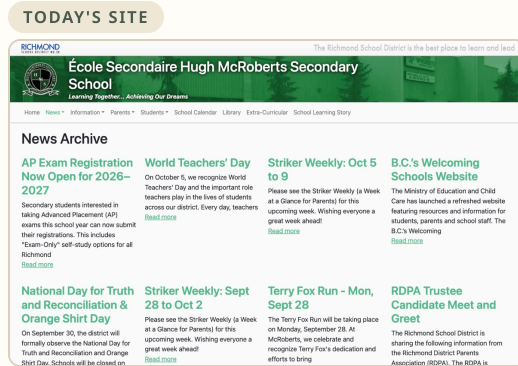
REDESIGN



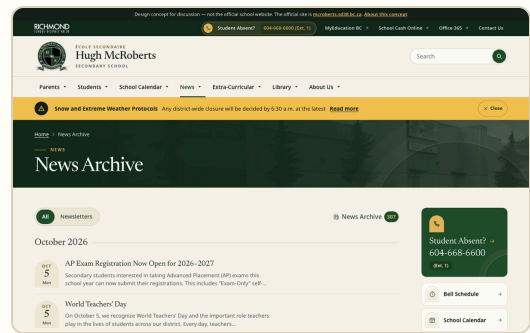
6

News

Every story shows its date, and the newsletters have their own filter. Today the news cards have no dates.



REDESIGN



Accessibility and speed, before and after

Measured with Lighthouse on a phone and from the files themselves. The big gains are in accessibility and in the heaviest files.

MEASURE	TODAY	REDESIGN
Lighthouse accessibility, home page on a phone	87	100
Lighthouse accessibility, Student Attendance on a phone	91	100
Lighthouse best practices, both pages	100	100
Contrast of link text (4.5 : 1 is the minimum)	2.4 : 1	8.8 : 1
Pages with more than one main heading	183 of 191	0 of 139
Pages where the absence number calls with one tap	Home page only	All 139
Career Centre photo	24.2 MB	363 KB
Heaviest page with its photos (a story with images pasted into the text)	3.9 MB	618 KB
All images on the site	31.7 MB	7.3 MB

Lighthouse SEO is not compared: the preview is set to stay out of search engines on purpose.

How it compares with the best school websites

I compared McRoberts with 12 of the best school websites today, most of them launched or awarded in 2025 or 2026, from BC to the UK, on a scale of 1 to 5, and scored the redesign the same way. The redesign's scores are my own, so please judge them on the preview.

AREA	TODAY	REDESIGN	BEST OF THE 12
Top tasks for parents and students	2	5	5 Eastside Catholic
Menu and site structure	3	5	5 Stevenson, Saint Xavier
Header and school identity	3	5	5 Brighton College, Saint Xavier
Home page story	2	4	5 Saint Xavier, Webb School
News	2	4	4 Walnut Grove, Stevenson
Events and calendar	2	4	4 Westdale, Fairfax Academy
Alerts and closures	2	4	4 Eastside Catholic, Walnut Grove
Look and feel	2	5	5 Brighton College, West Island College, Saint Xavier
Photos	2	3	5 Brighton College, Webb School
Accessibility	3	4	4 Shenton College, James Ruse
Translation	3	1	5 Fort Smith
On a phone	2	4	4 Eastside Catholic, Westdale
Total, out of 60	28	48	

How to adopt it

- 1

Look at the live preview on a phone and on a computer.
- 2

Download the Drupal theme (<https://rajool.github.io/mcroberts-redesign/downloads/mcroberts-drupal-theme.zip>) and pass it to whoever looks after our site at the district.
- 3

Try it on a staging copy first. A Platform.sh branch environment copies the live site's content, so the real site does not change while it is tested.
- 4

When it looks right, make the new theme the default and apply its settings for menus, page addresses and blocks.
- 5

If anything goes wrong, make the current theme the default again and run the theme's undo script (the steps are in its README).

Thank you for reading this, and for everything you and the staff do for our kids. I would love to hear what you think.

Ali Rajool

McRoberts parent and PAC Co-Treasurer